Name:
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الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES
EL117
Academic Writing
Main - All Branches
MTA Exam
2025-2026 /Spring
Date: 14 April 2026
2:30 – 4:00

Section: _____

Number of Exam Pages: 9 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed:**	**1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTION

There are THREE sections in this exam paper:

You are required to answer ALL the sections.

1. In section 1, apply the learned skills for writing focus by answering analytical questions related to unity, cohesion, structure, and mechanics of writing.
2. In section 2, choose only one topic and outline a four-paragraph essay.
3. In section 3, write a standard essay: start with an introduction, develop well-written body paragraphs, and end with a concluding paragraph. After you finish writing your essay, edit and proofread it paying attention to grammar, punctuation, and spelling.
4. Cross out any notes you make which you do not want to be considered.
5. Devote 5 minutes for reading through the whole paper and making the appropriate selection of questions.

Question Number	Minutes	Mark allocated (per question)	Earned Mark	Marker's Initials & Signature
Section I: Writing Focus & Editing	20	10		
Section II: Essay Outlining	15	5		
Section III: Essay Writing	55	15		
Total in Figures		30		

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Total in Letters	90 Minutes	Thirty Marks		

Section	1	Writing Focus & Editing	10 POINTS	20 MINUTES

Choose the right answer from a, b, c, or d. *(1 point each)*

1. Which sentence uses commas correctly?

a. In addition, students must cite their sources properly.
b. In addition students must cite their sources properly.
c. In addition students, must cite their sources properly.
d. In addition, students, must cite their sources properly.

2. Which sentence uses correct parallel structure?

a. The course aims to improve students' writing skills, critical thinking, and how they analyze texts.
b. The course aims to improve students' writing skills, critical thinking, and textual analysis.
c. The course aims to improve writing skills, thinking critically, and to textual analysis.
d. The course aims to improve students' writing skills, to think critically, and textual analysis.

3. Which sentence best combines the pairs of clauses to form a correct sentence?

(Clauses: The policy was implemented. Many employees resisted the change. They feared job losses.)

a. The policy was implemented, but many employees resisted the change although they feared job losses.
b. Although the policy was implemented, many employees resisted the change, and they feared job losses.
c. The policy was implemented, and many employees resisted the change, and they feared job losses.
d. When the policy was implemented, many employees resisted the change because they feared job losses.

4. Choose the revision that has correct subject-verb agreement in the following sentences.

a. The effects of climate change is becoming more visible every year.
b. The effects of climate change are becoming more visible every year.
c. The effects of climate change has become more visible every year.
d. The effects of climate change becomes more visible every year.

5. What do the underlined words in bold do? *"Many students struggle with time management. **For example, some delay starting assignments until the night before the deadline**."*

a. Show order.
b. Show result.

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c. Show a reason.
d. Give an example.

6. Which of the following sentences is a run-on sentence?

a. Many students prefer online courses because they offer flexibility.
b. Many students prefer online courses they offer flexibility.
c. Many students prefer online courses; they offer flexibility.
d. Many students prefer online courses, for they offer flexibility.

7. Choose the correct description of this sentence fragment *"While the researchers were conducting the experiment."*

a. It is missing a subject.
b. It is missing a verb.
c. It is a dependent clause not connected to an independent clause.
d. It expresses a complete thought.

8. Read the following introductory paragraph, and then select the most appropriate <u>thesis statement.</u>

In recent years, artificial intelligence has become deeply integrated into educational settings. From automated grading systems to personalized learning platforms, AI technologies are transforming how students learn and how instructors teach. While these innovations promise efficiency and customization, they also raise important ethical and pedagogical concerns. The growing presence of AI in education demands careful examination.

.....

a. Artificial intelligence is widely used in many different industries today.
b. The integration of artificial intelligence in education presents both significant benefits and serious challenges that must be critically evaluated.
c. Many universities have recently adopted artificial intelligence tools.
d. Artificial intelligence will completely replace teachers in the future.

9. Read the following paragraph, and then select the most appropriate <u>topic sentence.</u>

..... Many students experience significant stress during exam periods. They often face pressure to achieve high grades while managing multiple deadlines. In addition, lack of sleep and poor time management can increase anxiety levels. Some students also feel overwhelmed by family expectations and competition with peers. If not addressed properly, academic stress may negatively affect both performance and mental health.

a. Exams are usually scheduled at the end of each semester.
b. Academic stress is a common challenge faced by university students.
c. Students study different subjects at university.
d. Family expectations are always harmful to students.

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10. Read the paragraph below, then choose the best <u>concluding sentence</u>.

Volunteering during university years can be extremely beneficial. To begin with, it helps students develop important soft skills such as communication and teamwork. Furthermore, volunteering allows students to build professional networks that may support their future careers. In addition, it enhances their sense of social responsibility and empathy toward others. Lastly, employers often value volunteer experience when evaluating job applications. _____.

a. Many students volunteer during the summer.
b. Some organizations offer certificates to volunteers.
c. Volunteering is usually unpaid work.
d. For these reasons, volunteering is a valuable experience for university students.

Section	2	Outlining	5 POINTS	15 MINUTES

<u>Outline ONE of the following topics using the graphic organizer below.</u> ***(5 points)***

1. Write a cause-and-effect essay examining the impact of remote work on employees' productivity. Discuss the influence of using digital communication platforms on communication among employees and the workplace dynamics. Provide concrete examples and real-life scenarios to support your discussion.

2. *"Failure is not the opposite of success; it is part of success."* Write a narrative essay about a time when you experienced failure that eventually led to personal growth or achievement. Describe the situation in detail, including the setting, the people involved, your emotions at the time, and the lessons you learned. Explain how this experience changed your perspective or influenced your future decisions.

Introductory Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Hook/Opening statement:

_____

_____

Thesis statement:

_____

_____

Body Paragraph (1): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (1):

_____

_____

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Major supporting details:

Body Paragraph (2): ***(1 point)***

Topic sentence (2):

Major supporting details:

Concluding Paragraph: ***(1.5 point)***

Restatement of the thesis:

Final comment:

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Section	3	Essay Writing	15 POINTS	55 MINUTES

Write a four-paragraph essay (300-350 words) on the same topic that you have outlined in the previous section. **(15 points)**

ALEXANDRIA

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